In a Factory Full of Screws, These Two Women Are Tightening the Bolts on India's Gender Gap

At Landmark Crafts Ltd in Panchkula, Rachna and Ruby Sharma are not just managers on the shop floor. They are the only women in India working hands-on in fastener manufacturing — and they are rewriting what that floor looks like.

Walk into most fastener manufacturing facilities in India and the picture is identical: rows of precision machinery, the rhythmic percussion of metal on metal, the focused concentration of workers managing tolerances measured in fractions of a millimetre, and an overwhelming, unbroken uniformity of male faces. The fastener industry is one of the most consequential in the country - the screws, rivets, and bolts it produces hold together the buildings we live in, the infrastructure we depend on, and the industrial assemblies that keep modern India functioning. And yet, for all its economic significance, it has remained one of the most gender-homogeneous manufacturing sectors in the nation.



At Landmark Crafts Private Limited in Panchkula, two women have decided that this is not a fact to be accepted. It is a problem to be solved. One shift, one production target, one precision audit at a time.

Rachna and Ruby Sharma are shop floor managers at one of India's largest manufacturers of HP Self Drilling Screws, Aluminium Blind Rivets, and Dry Wall Screws. They do not occupy administrative roles or support functions on the periphery of

> *When I first came to this floor, I had to learn everything from scratch. The machines do not care whether you are a man or a woman. What they respond to is understanding, respect for the process, and attention to the detail the product demands. That is what I bring every single day, and that is what this floor expects of anyone who stands on it.*

RACHNA
Landmark Crafts Ltd
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